

TECHNICAL REPORT

Data Storm 7.0 — Preliminary Round | Team: CodeStormers

1. Data Forensics and Hygiene

1.1 Data Landscape Assessment

We received 5 raw datasets from legacy SFA and distributor ERP systems spanning ~20,000 outlets across 4 provinces (Western, Central, North-Western, Southern) served by 10 distributors.

Dataset	Records	Key Issues Found
transactions_history_final.csv	~2M+	Negative volumes, extreme outliers, duplicate SKU-month entries, orphan outlet IDs
outlet_master.csv	~20,000	Typos in Outlet_Type ("Grocry"), inconsistent casing, duplicate Outlet_IDs
outlet_coordinates.csv	~20,000	Coordinates outside Sri Lanka bounding box, null lat/lon
distributor_seasonality_details.csv	~360	Inconsistent seasonality labels
holiday_list.csv	~100+	Dates in ISO format with timezone, out-of-order entries

1.2 Lakehouse Architecture

We implemented a 3-layer Lakehouse pipeline to ensure data integrity and traceability:

- **Bronze (Raw Ingestion):** Preserves the original state with lineage manifest (timestamp, source, file sizes).
- **Silver (Cleaned):** 10+ parameterizable DQ checks applied per dataset with full quarantine storage.
- **Gold (Enriched):** Final layer containing enriched features, peer benchmarks, and potential predictions.

1.3 Reusable Data Quality Library

Our pipeline utilizes six modular, parameterizable DQ functions:

- **Duplicate Check:** Composite primary key deduplication.
- **Null Check:** Mandatory field completeness validation.
- **Referential Integrity:** Cross-dataset foreign key validation.
- **Value Range:** Numeric boundary enforcement (e.g., Volume ≥ 0, Lat ∈ [5.5, 10.0]).
- **Format/Type:** Regex-based ID validation and robust date parsing.
- **Outlier Detection:** IQR-based extreme value detection (3× IQR).

1.4 Quarantine Policy

Zero data loss: Every failed record is quarantined to `silver/quarantined/` with a `_quarantine_reason` annotation. This ensures transparency and allows for future data recovery or manual correction.

2. POI Data Acquisition

2.1 External Data Strategy

Leveraging the **OpenStreetMap Overpass API**, we enriched the internal dataset with geospatial signals to capture demand drivers that are not present in historical sales data.

Category	OSM Tag	Relevance
Schools	amenity=school	High foot traffic; parents and students frequent nearby shops.
Hospitals	amenity=hospital	Consistent visitor traffic and 24/7 beverage demand.
Bus Stops	highway=bus_stop	Transit hubs drive high-volume impulse purchases.

2.2 Feature Engineering from POIs

For each outlet, we computed proximity features including count-based metrics (radii of 500m, 1km, 2km) and a **Composite Accessibility Score**:

$$Score = 0.30 \times bus_score + 0.35 \times school_score + 0.35 \times hospital_score$$

All POI queries were batched and cached to ensure API efficiency and reproducibility.

3. Causal Base Logic — Demand Uncapping

3.1 The Censoring Problem

Historical sales volume is **left-censored**: *Observed_Volume = min(True_Demand, Supply_Constraint)*. To solve this, we used a multiplicative framework:

$$Potential = Base \times Seasonality \times POI_Uplift \times Growth \times Cooler$$

3.2 Base Potential (Peer-Benchmarked)

We define a "Peer Group" based on `Outlet_Type × Size × Region`. The base potential is uncapped using:

$$Base = \max(Own_P95, Peer_P90 \times 0.8, Historical_Max)$$

3.3 Constraint Detection

Outlets hitting distribution ceilings are identified by a **Low CV** (Coefficient of Variation < 0.15) or a high ratio of months near their historical maximum. These outlets receive an **Uncapping Multiplier** ranging from 1.1x to 1.3x based on their gap relative to top-performing peers.

4. GenAI Transparency Log

Generative AI was used as an **engineering accelerator** across all phases of the project.

Phase	AI Tool	Purpose
Architecture	Gemini	Lakehouse structure planning and DQ function design.
Code Gen	Gemini	Generating boilerplate for POI scraping and DQ scripts.
Methodology	Gemini	Refining the mathematical logic for demand uncapping.

5. Results & Conclusions

Our analysis indicates that legacy system artifacts significantly mask true demand. By combining **Peer Benchmarking** with **External POI signals**, we have developed a robust framework to "uncap" this demand, providing a data-driven path for resource allocation and cooler deployment for January 2026.